

electricity, or just static. All components inside a computer conduct electricity. So even if these devices are not inside the computer, they are packed in an anti-static bag to protect it from stray currents of electricity, of which our bodies too, are sources. These components are extremely sensitive to static electricity, also known as electrostatic discharge (ESD). ESD can damage a device the first time you touch it if proper precautions are not taken. So, even before you have used that spanking new video card, thanks to static, you could have already destroyed it.

To prevent this, the simplest (and least expensive) way is to ground or earth yourself before you touch anything inside the computer. You can do this by touching a metal object (such as the sides of the computer tower or a metal rod) for some time. Only then, should you start taking apart your computer. Or, you can wear an anti-static strap at all times when working with the computer to make sure you don't damage anything. This method is the more recommended one. You can purchase an anti-static wrist strap from any computer hardware store.

Now that you have the necessary tools at hand, find a place to disassemble the computer. Ideally, the place you would want to operate on your computer should be illuminated well and static-free. That means, no working on carpeted floors. Choose a stable

